Chapter 2 Basics of Food

2.1 Assessing Student's Daily Diet

Aim: To assess the student's daily diet using 'Basic Food Group'.

Importance of basic four food groups

Foods have been classified based on the nutritive value. This helps in planning meals.

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Table 2.1 Importance of Basic Four Food Groups

S. No.	Food Groups	Main Nutrients	Dietary guidelines (or) Tips
1	**Cereals, millets and pulses:** Rice, wheat, bajra, maize, ragi, jowar, barley, rice flakes, wheat flour, malted cereals, Bengal gram, black gram, green gram, red gram (whole as well as dhals), cow pea, peas, rajmah, soya bean, beans, horse gram and sprouted pulses	Energy, protein, invisible fat, thiamine, riboflavin, folic acid, iron, calcium and fibre	• A combination of millets and cereals can be included to enhance the B vitamins, calcium, iron and fibre. • The ratio of cereal protein to pulse protein should be 4:1 to improve protein quality. • Add soya bean because it has valuable pulse protein. • Take at least 2 servings of pulses per day (60g)
2	**Vegetables and Fruits** **Green leafy vegetables (G.L.V):** Amaranth, spinach, drumstick leaves, beetroot leaves, coriander leaves, curry leaves, mustard leaves, fenugreek leaves	Carotenoids, riboflavin, folic acid, calcium, iron, fibre	• Include green leafy vegetables in daily diet
	Other vegetables: Carrot, onion, brinjal, ladies finger, capsicum, beans, drumstick, cauliflower	Carotenoids, folic acid, calcium, fibre	• At least one medium size fruit should be included per day
	Fruits: Guava, tomato, mango ripe, papaya, orange, sweet lime, water melon, grapes, amla	Carotenoids, vitamin-C, fibre	• Include at least 100 g green leafy vegetables and 100 g fruit in the diet

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